

open-ear design with dual drivers must come at a cost, right? Wrong.

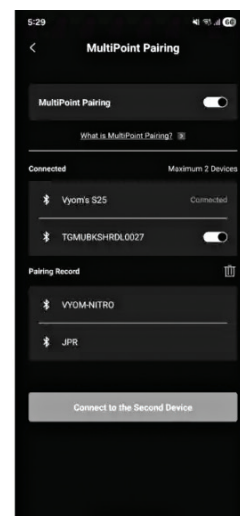
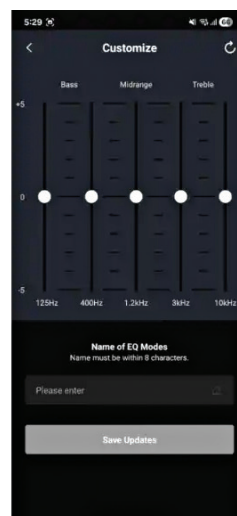
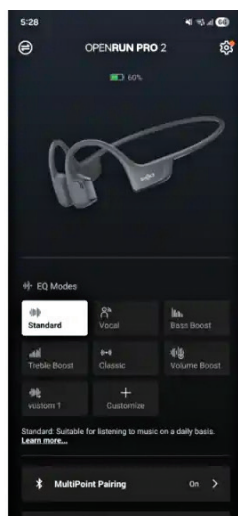
The OpenRun Pro 2 has been nothing short of phenomenal for me. I consistently get over 14 hours of continuous playback, which means I can go through a full workday, head to the gym, and still have juice left over. That reliability is a game-changer, because I never have to ration my usage.

And when it does finally need charging, it bounces back fast. I timed a full recharge from zero to 100% at just under 45 minutes. For me, that's the difference between an inconvenient dead headset and a quick top-up during lunch. It's the kind of charging speed that turns the headset into a near-always-ready companion.

Outdoor performance

Here's where the OpenRun Pro 2 earns its stripes. I primarily use it for running, and in that environment, it's just about perfect. Running in a city like Mumbai has always been stressful for me – bikes coming from behind, cars pulling out of side streets, horns, sirens. With traditional earbuds, I either had to keep the volume really low or risk being blindsided. With the OpenRun Pro 2, my ears are completely open. I can hear music and my surroundings simultaneously. That alone makes me want to keep using them.

That said, the design isn't perfect for every workout. The wraparound band becomes a nuisance for floor work.



When I lie back for bench presses or crunches, the band pushes against the floor or bench, shifting the headset. It's distracting enough that I don't bother with them for horizontal exercises. And in a noisy gym, the lack of isolation means I'm at the mercy of clanking weights and blaring house tracks.

Sound quality and customisation

I'll be honest – I went in with modest expectations. Bone conduction has never been known for great sound. But the OpenRun Pro 2 surprised me.

The midrange performance is excellent, which makes podcasts, audiobooks, and calls sound crystal clear. Music, on the other hand, is where I noticed the impact of the DualPitch system. With bass support from the normal drivers, EDM and rock tracks had genuine punch. Treble clarity was also decent, making vocals and cymbals pop more than I thought possible for this type of headset.

Through the companion app, there are 4 EQ presets in India – Standard, Vocal, Bass Boost and Treble Boost. You also have the option to set a custom EQ according to your sound preference if the presets don't suit you. Here's where I hit a weird snag: the "Volume Boost" and the so-called "Classic" mode isn't available in India. I had to set my region to the U.S. to access it while registering on the Shokz app. Classic mode disables

the air conduction speaker, leaving only bone conduction active. The result is way more cheekbone vibration, but the overall sound quality takes a noticeable hit. It's interesting as a novelty, but I stuck with the DualPitch default. It just sounds better all around.



The downsides

While the OpenRun Pro 2 is a strong performer in active and office environments, I found it entirely unsuitable for certain leisure activities. While gaming, it exhibits noticeable high latency (audio lag) in the absence of a dedicated low-latency mode. Despite the comfortable upright fit and durable case, the headset is a poor travel companion. It's not flawless, but it's the most reliable, awareness-focused headset out there. **d**

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